i wish i could unrecall (how we almost had it all)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/58738564.

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Not Rated

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by softnoiir

Summary

Catra's mind screamed at her to stop. To slash her face, to knock her out cold, to do anything to get Adora away from her. To get She-Ra away. But her heart whispered at her to indulge in the moment for just a few seconds, to allow herself to enjoy just this one thing.

And that was it, it was all Catra needed to give in.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

A shrill alarm cut through the air, red lights flashing wildly, sending a wave of silent gasps through the room. Scorpia, Catra, and Entrapta exchanged wide-eyed looks, their shock mirroring the sudden chaos.

Catra clutched the sword protectively, holding onto it tighter upon hearing the blaring noise. Her ears flattened against her head and she rolled her eyes, “Ugh, it's probably more rebel idiots. Scorpia, go deal with that, I’ll keep an eye on Adora.” Catra instructed not even sparing a passing glance at Scorpia, instead smirking at all the possibilities that now lay in front of her thanks to the sword that rested right in her palms.

The sword which allowed her to control She-Ra on a whim, which can turn her from a prim and proper princess into an uncontrollable weapon that only *she* can stop.

The sword that left She-Ra, *Adora*, helpless in her hands.

Adora. Catra is reminded of the unconscious person that she was supposedly keeping an eye on. Her eyes widened to see an empty floor where Adora was supposed to be. She frantically looked around in search of her, only to find nothing. Without skipping a beat, Entrapta raised her left pigtail and pointed towards the closet to their side, “She went that way,” she said casually, not even looking up from her computer as she continued typing away words that Catra couldn't even understand.

Catra mumbled a half-hearted thanks and took off towards the direction Entrapta pointed in. She entered the room only to find it seemingly empty. She rummaged around potential hiding spots Adora could be hiding in but to no avail. Catra rolls her eyes and huffs in annoyance, deciding it was time to retreat and go back to the main room.

Should have known Entrapta was full of shit. Catra thought as she began typing the exit code to leave the room. That is until she heard quiet giggles from the farthest corner of the room.

“What the-?” Catra mumbled, unsure if she was hearing correctly, “Adora?” she called out, half annoyed and half confused. What was her plan, anyway? To annoy Catra until she gave up and handed her back the sword? Yeah, over her dead body.

She heard more giggling followed by small and quick footsteps coming towards her. She rolled her eyes upon hearing that. She stepped away from the keypad and secured the sword on the satchel on her back. “Adora, I know that’s you,” she continued, crossing her arms.

Silence followed and Catra decided to take matters into her own hands. She stealthily walked over to where she heard the footsteps go in an attempt to catch Adora off guard, but she was nowhere to be found.

Catra groans in annoyance, growing tired of whatever game Adora is playing at.

Suddenly, Catra is tackled from behind. She gets pushed off balance and lands on the floor.

“Get off of me!” she yelled as Adora falls on top of her.

“You found me!” Adora cheered gleefully as if they were a couple of kids playing a game of hide and seek in the barracks of the Horde. She wore a lopsided grin on her face and her eyebrows laid unevenly on her forehead.

Adora propped herself on her elbows to prevent herself from crushing Catra from underneath. Their faces were a mere few inches apart as Adora suddenly had no concept of personal space. There they laid an entangled mess.

Catra’s breath hitched at the sudden contact, “What are you-” she started but was interrupted by Adora’s fit of giggles, “What are you doing?” she gritted through her teeth trying to ignore the sickening smile Adora was giving her. Adora was looking at her with stars in her eyes. Looking at her as if they were teens again

back at the horde. Looking at her as if they haven't been bitter enemies for the past year or so.

“Playing hide and seek, duh!” Adora said a matter of factly. She rolled her eyes playfully and inched her face closer to Catra, “And you won! Congratulations!” she cheered again, her grin extending even more. She would have started clapping if only her arms weren't being used to balance herself atop Catra.

Catra, who was still utterly confused about why Adora was acting like this, only groaned. *Was this the side effect of being corrupted by Entrapta’s freaky tech?* She thought to herself, analyzing Adora’s face. Must be, right? There was no other plausible explanation for, Adora flutters her eyelashes at Catra, all *this* .

“Yeah, yeah, save your praise. Can you get off of me now?” Catra retorted and attempted to push Adora away. Amidst all this, Adora was still as strong as ever.

“Oopsies,” Adora giggled, immediately getting up to find something else to distract herself with. She ran over towards where Catra initially was, the exit door, and started pressing random numbers on the keypad.

“Get back here!” Catra quickly got up and followed Adora, trying to get ahold of her before she manages to open the door and escape.

Though Catra doesn't worry too much about it, she doubts Adora will. The passcode was something only she would know.

As if on cue, the door slid open and Catra could only look at Adora with a shocked expression on her face, eyebrows raised and her mouth agape, “How the hell did you know the code?”

Adora shrugged, “I put in your favorite number,” she replied casually as if Catra’s favorite number was some common fact everyone should know.

A cold breeze enters the room and Adora starts shivering. She curls into a ball on the floor and pushes herself on Catra’s leg for extra warmth.

Catra’s eye twitched, “More like a lucky guess,” she replied, not wanting to believe that Adora remembered something as mundane as her favorite number. As if she'd care enough to remember anything about Catra.

Catra lightly kicks Adora away from her leg to which Adora merely giggles at her

“Nuh-uh!” Adora stood up from her sitting position and got face to face with Catra, “I know all your favorite things!”

“I am not doing this with you right now. Or ever. Let’s get back to Entrapta before you run off again.” Catra grabs Adora by the wrists and drags her over to the door.

A loud roaring noise got their attention. They looked outside and saw gigantic bug-like creatures that looked like they could swallow them whole. Catra’s eyes widened and immediately pulled Adora back inside, closing the door behind the two of them. There was still a slight chill in the air but nothing they couldn’t both manage.

“I guess we're staying here until Scorpia’s able to come get us,” Catra mumbles to herself but Adora picks up on it.

Adora beams at that, “Sleepover!” She drapes her arms around Catra's neck and starts cheering, jumping up and down as if she just won the war.

“Stop it! Stop being weird!” Catra yelled, pushing her back. She was not looking forward to being stuck here for god knows how long with little miss sunshine.

Adora pouts and crosses her arms, “You're mean,”

“Yeah, well nothing new there.” Catra retorts back, walking back further into the room to sit on one of the dusty old boxes. The

chill in the air is suddenly more noticeable and Catra begins rubbing her arms to keep herself warm.

Adora picked up on the cold too. She shivered and walked over to where Catra was, sitting beside her, snuggling up to her side.

“Get away from me!” Catra yelled, clearly irritated, moving away from Adora.

But Adora didn't take the hint. She, again, sat beside her and this time wrapped her arms around her waist.

Catra got fed up. She pushes Adora off to the side and she flops onto the ground with a loud thud. “Ow!” Adora groans, rubbing the part of her arm that felt the most tender, “Stop being so mean!” she yelled back with furrowed eyebrows in an attempt to look intimidating.

Well, as intimidating as she could with her current puppy dog-like features.

“Well get used to it!” Catra replies coldly, scooting away from Adora.

Adora shook her head, pointing a finger straight at Catra’s nose, “You used to be nice!” she thought for a moment, “Well, nice- *ish* ,”

“Me? Nice? Please, maybe this disk thing infected you too much,” Catra laughed in response. Sure she was never as bad as she was now but she wouldn't exactly have called herself nice. No one in the horde is. *Well* . Expect Adora, she guesses, but she doesn't count anymore.

“Were too! *You,* ” once again, Adora points a finger towards Catra, “Gave me gray ration bars, which by the way, are so much better than the brown kind,” she started counting on her fingers, listing times Catra had been ‘nice’ to her, “Comforted me when Shadow Weaver was mean, cuddled with me when I was scared,”

Catra turned around, not wanting to face Adora as she began listing random insignificant moments that held no importance now. Her heart started pounding loudly for reasons she wasn't entirely sure of.

This irritated her. How dare Adora think so fondly of her. After all they've been through in the war? After all Catra's done to Adora? And she has the nerve to still call her nice?

"What changed?" Adora asked in a quiet voice. This snapped Catra out of her thoughts. She was about to turn around but hesitated, instead remained with her back turned to Adora.

"What do you," Catra pauses, trying to collect her thoughts. There was suddenly a lump in her throat, "What do you mean?" she asked, but she already knew the answer to that.

"What changed? Why did *you* change?" Adora was still slurring her words out yet Catra understood every single one as clear as day.

Catra took a deep breath, "It's complicated, okay?" she held her breath in, rubbing her elbow, now embarrassed that she was having this conversation with what can only be described as a drunken Adora.

Adora was silent for a moment and Catra allowed herself to exhale, silently hoping that that was the end of it. Why was she even putting up with this, anyway? Adora was helpless, she could easily tie her up and tape her mouth shut. That would get her to shut up.

She'd be free of her questions, free of these bubbling thoughts, and free of the sinking feeling that's pulling her deeper and deeper in.

She despised that feeling that seemed to cling to her, that persistent ache that weaved itself into her very core. It left her heart exposed and vulnerable, making her feel weak, a feeling she despised deeply. There were moments where she yearned to cast

Adora from her thoughts entirely, to permanently erase her from her memories. The thought of her served as nothing but a bitter reminder of what they could have had. Of what they could have been.

Suddenly, Catra heard footsteps shuffling from behind her. Slowly, she turns around to see what Adora was doing, only to be met face to face with her once more. This time, Catra doesn't shy away, holding steady eye contact. Adora smiles weekly at her right before entrapping her in a hug. A hug Catra hasn't felt in a *really* long time.

Catra was stunned for a moment, not entirely sure how she should react. They were supposed to be enemies, bitter rivals wanting nothing but the worst for each other. Catra should use this as an opportunity to end the war for good. What's the rebellion without their precious She-Ra, anyway?

But she wasn't She-Ra right now, was she?

She was just Adora. Stubborn, annoying, dense, idiotic Adora.

Adora, who left her for a life of rainbows and unicorns. Who left the only home she'd ever known for people whom she met a mere hours before.

Adora, who was the only person that actually made her feel like a human being. The only one who kept her sanity in check whenever Shadow Weaver subjected her through all those hours of torture.

Adora, who was able to look past all the rage and aggression the Horde had instilled in her, seeing her for who she truly was.

Adora, who was now holding her like she was the most precious thing she had ever touched.

Adora, who was her supposed enemy, who *is* her enemy.

But that was them outside, them on the battlefield with everyone around watching with prying eyes. It's what they are when the Horde, the Rebellion, Sparkles, Arrow Boy, and everyone else are watching.

It was what they had to be. They couldn't be anything more. Not after Adora left the Horde, not after Adora left *her* .

But now, there was no one watching them. No stupid rebellion friends to steal Adora away, no Shadow Weave threatening Catra's life if she didn't convince Adora to come home. No one to take this moment away from them.

It was just Catra, Adora, and the solitude of this closet.

But Catra shouldn't, right? She would regret doing *anything* she wanted to do here, the self-hatred she knew she would feel for succumbing to her weakness. Not to mention how horrified Adora would be once she sobers up and realizes what she and Catra had been doing while she was still suffering the aftereffects of the disk.

Catra's hands twitch. But Adora isn't sober right now, is she? Would she even remember any of this once the disk wears off?

Fuck it, Catra breathes, taking in the sight before her. There Adora stood, with her arms wrapped around her neck, and her chin cradled on her head. She could feel the stray hairs that fell from her ponytail on top of her head, just as she could feel her body heat transferring over to her.

And how her heartbeat held a steady pace, as opposed to Catra, who felt as if her heart was about to burst out of her chest.

With a hesitant hand, Catra slowly began to hug her back. Her mind screamed at her to stop. To slash her face, to knock her out cold, to do *anything* to get Adora away from her. To get She-Ra away. But her heart whispered at her to indulge in the hug for just a few seconds, to allow herself to enjoy just this one thing. That was all Catra needed to give in.

She wrapped her arms around Adora's waist and buried her face in the crook of her neck. She could feel Adora smiling through their hug and felt her instinctively pull her closer. Catra closed her eyes to savor this moment knowing this would be the last time she would ever get to hold Adora like this.

"I miss you," Adora murmured, it was muffled in Catra's hair but Catra heard all the same.

Adora started playing with her hair, lightly pulling loose strands, curling them around her fingers then letting them fall free. Slowly, she made her way up towards her ears. When her fingertips made contact with them, they twitched away, but Adora knew that that was just their instinctive reaction.

Adora slowly reached for Catra's ears and started stroking them just how Catra liked. She began to purr at the now foreign contact that was once a common gesture between them.

Catra feels her heart swell at how much she realized she missed this. At the realization that she missed *her* .

She missed the way Adora looked at her like she was her whole world. The way her eyes sparkled and her eyebrows curved. Her stupid half smile and half smirk she would give Catra whenever she had her " *I told you so* " moments.

She missed randomly tackling Adora whenever they raced each other around the Fright Zone. Holding her hand underneath the table at dinner. Cuddling and holding each other late at night, realizing their bodies fit so perfectly together, like puzzle pieces that found their exact match.

Like how they're doing right now.

Her heart hurt thinking about her life without ever feeling this again. Was the horde really more important to her than Adora?

But Shadow Weaver, she'd have her head if Catra would even consider doing what she was thinking right now.

But then, she would be with *Adora* . They would figure it out. They always did.

But would Adora even want her back on her side? After all they've been through, after all she's done, would Adora ever forgive her?

This mental back and forth between Catra and her inner thoughts was nothing new to her, but only now did she feel a side starting to win. Before, she would only choose survival, but what if she allowed herself to actually *live* .

Catra pulls back, guiding Adora to look her directly in the eyes. Adora smiles at her with the look of- *love?* no, the look of something they really shouldn't be feeling for each other right now.

Nonetheless, it was how Adora looked at Catra.

Adora continued looking at Catra with *that* look in her eyes which made Catra want to say what she wanted to even more.

Catra opens her mouth to speak, to reply to Adora's previous statement, to verbalize even a small percentage of how she truly feels.

But before she could utter a single word, the door suddenly slides open revealing Sea Hawk standing proudly.

The cold breeze knocks the words right out of Catra's mouth, and she immediately pushes Adora away. Adora lands on the ground with another thud.

And just like that, the moment slipped through their fingers, vanishing as they were pulled back to the present. The solitude they had so cherished dissolved, replaced by the stark reminder of their somber reality.

Much like all their other fleeting moments together.

“Adora! I've come to rescue you!” he yells all heroically which makes Catra's ears bleed. She snaps out of the lovesick spell Adora had somehow put her under with a simple 3 words and immediately goes to attack the estranged man.

Catra screams in frustration at god knows what. Was she annoyed at Sea Hawk for interrupting whatever was going on with her and Adora? Or at Adora for being the only person whom she had trusted with her heart, only for her to rip it out from her chest without her even knowing?

Or at herself for allowing even a second of this deluded nonsense to cloud her judgment.

Catra jumps onto Sea Hawk. She strangles him from behind using the sword, and he topples backward, losing balance. He falls to the ground but immediately stands up ready to continue the fight. He throws sloppy punches at Catra which she easily avoids. She returns the favor by swiping a claw at his face. A minuscule scar appears, drawing blood from his cheek as he was barely able to miss the hit. Catra smirks at him, letting the rest of her claws out.

“More like I'm here to rescue you” Adora giggles as if this were some game. Sea Hawk looks at her, dumbfounded, “What’s wrong with her?” he asks out of breath.

Catra gives him no time to recover as she's already back on her feet, trying to land another hit on him, “Beats me,” she responds indifferently.

Catra swipes Sea Hawk's foot with her leg, sending him flailing backward onto a pile of old boxes. Catra sees this as an opportunity to end the fight for good. She pins Sea Hawk down and prepares for the final blow, “Any last words?” she asks cockily, right before a flash of pink and purple appears a few feet away from them.

Catra is momentarily distracted by this and Sea Hawk takes this as an opportunity to reverse their roles. He tackles Catra, pushing

her to the side, in a desperate attempt to grab hold of the sword, but to no avail.

“Friends!” Adora yells joyfully, running up to her 2 best friends engulfing them in a bone-crushing hug.

“Nice to see you too Adora,” Bow humors her before tightly grabbing her wrists, “Now let's get your sword back,” he says to which Adora cheers at.

“I'd love to see you all try,” Catra says. There's a crazed look in her eye now. What was usually tame and skillfully hidden in the depths of her mind was now out in the open.

She was so *tired* .

Tired of always losing to the rebellion, to *Adora* . For once she just wanted, no, needed a win. And she wasn't going to let any of them stop her.

“Give it up Catra, three against one, I think we all know how this is going to end,” Glimmer remarked as she stepped closer to Catra, cornering her even more. Bow and Sea Hawk followed suit, mirroring Glimmer’s stance.

They kept walking towards her until Catra's back was flat against the exit door. She was trapped, unable to punch in the code on the keypad as Bow had shot at it earlier.

“It's over,” Bow said and Catra shook her head no.

“No, as long as I’m standing, you will never get your hands on this sword,” Catra held out her claws, prepared to fight until her very last breath. She'd die before allowing them to have the sword back.

Then, as if on cue, the door opens revealing Scorpia. The gust of cold hair rushes in the room, knocking everyone back. Scorpia notices the predicament Catra is in and immediately grabs hold of

her, carrying her back to the main room, “Let's get you out of here, wildcat.”

Catra takes a final lingering look over her shoulder, her gaze drifting to Adora who also catches her eye. Time seemed to pause as they held the gaze. The moment stretches, heavy with unspoken words and shared history, as she takes Adora in one last time before turning away, carrying the weight of their memories with her.

She clutched the sword safe in her hands. *Whatever.* She didn't need Adora, anyway. She didn't *need* anyone. She already had She-Ra’s sword, and soon, she'd have the Rebellion eating from the palms of her hands.

End Notes

hi !

truthfully i haven't properly written anything in 2 or so years and picked up this old draft to see if I still had it in me lol but nonetheless, thank you sm for reading this short thing and I hope you enjoyed ^^

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!